6.3 Restricting access to views

With a little configuration, Django handles the authentication of a user account (more on this in a bit); the authorization of an action is up to you. The simplest form of authorization is to allow anyone that has an active account to take an action. When you wrap a view with the built-in `@login_required` decorator, that view's authorization is restricted to only users with accounts.

Let's start by creating a new page that can only be viewed by authenticated users. As the view needs to show some content, you're going to need a new template. An all-purpose template can be handy for messaging the user; all it needs is a single variable displayed using the `| safe` filter, allowing you to write HTML content into the page. Create RiffMates/templates/general.html, and insert the content from the following listing.

Listing 6.3 A generic template that can be used by many views to message the user

```
<!-- RiffMates/templates/general.html -->
{% extends "base.html" %}

{% block title %}
  {{block.super}}: {{title}}
{% endblock %}

{% block content %}
  {{content|safe}}
{% endblock content %}
```

Inherit the base template for a look and feel consistent with the rest of your website.

Alter the page's title.

Use the | safe filter to prevent HTML content being escaped by Django.

Any view using this template can show arbitrary HTML to the user by populating `content` in the context dictionary. The `restricted_page` view has very little logic; it simply renders an HTML message using the general.html template. Wrapping the view in the `@login_required` decorator takes care of the authorization. Add the code in the following listing to RiffMates/bands/views.py, creating your first view with authorization.

Listing 6.4 A view only visible to authenticated users

```
# RiffMates/bands/views.py
from django.contrib.auth.decorators import
➥ login_required
...
@login_required
def restricted_page(request):
    data = {
        'title': 'Restricted Page',
        'content': '<h1>You are logged in</h1>',
    }

    return render(request, "general.html", data)
```

Import the authorization decorator.

Wrap the view requiring authentication.

The HTML message to display in the rendered page

Render content using the generic template.